

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

The CLARITY Act Pillar Report

The Crypto Rules Bill — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

*Originally written **June 5, 2026**; scores committed by me on **June 12, 2026**. Previously updated **July 8, July 10, and July 13, 2026**, with daily catch-up/light checks on **July 17 and July 18, 2026**. **This version is a full weekly research refresh (July 18, superseding that same day's light touch)** that independently re-verified the record-low prediction-market read and corrected a stale piece of context this report was carrying: Sen. Lindsey Graham's Senate seat was **not** left vacant — it was refilled within 48 hours of his death — so the "GOP floor majority thinned to ~51" framing used to justify part of the July 13 cut no longer holds, though it's offset by the still-unresolved ethics deadlock. This version carries re-rated **DRAFT** scores awaiting my stamp.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 5, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified July 18, 2026 (full weekly refresh) · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 12, 2026. July 8 through July 17 drafts shown for full lineage — nothing collapses until I commit a newer set. July 18 draft is this week's full research refresh (confirms, does not further cut, the same-day light-touch level) — NOT stamped yet. Signals below run off the July 18 draft.

WINDOW	MY JUNE P	JUL 8	JUL 10	JUL 11	JUL 12	JUL 13	JUL 17	JUL 18	QUALITY	IMPACT	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	55	52	50	52	52	50	48	44	0.85	8	-0.82	Mild Bear — record-low prediction-market read confirmed, no cloture filed
3 months	60	56	54	55	55	54	52	48	0.85	8	-0.27	Neutral (slight bear lean)
6 months	65	61	60	61	61	61	61	59	0.85	8	+1.22	Mild Bull
1 year	85	83	82	82	82	82	82	82	0.90	8	+4.61	Strong Bull
3 years	92	92	92	92	92	92	92	92	0.95	8	+6.38	Very Strong Bull

Draft P (Jul 18, full weekly refresh): 44 / 48 / 59 / 82 / 92 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P – 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Lineage: June committed 55 / 60 / 65 / 85 / 92 (June 12, 2026) → July 8 draft 52 / 56 / 61 / 83 / 92 → July 10 draft 50 / 54 / 60 / 82 / 92 → July 11 draft 52 / 55 / 61 / 82 / 92 → July 12 draft 52 / 55 / 61 / 82 / 92 (held flat) → July 13 draft 50 / 54 / 61 / 82 / 92 (full refresh, Graham's death) → July 17 draft 48 / 52 / 61 / 82 / 92 (catch-up, NDAA delay + falling odds) → July 18 draft 44 / 48 / 59 / 82 / 92 (light-touch record-low-odds cut, independently confirmed by this week's full refresh — held, not cut further) — awaiting my stamp.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. Near-term now clearly below a coin flip: prediction-market passage odds hit a fresh record low near 32% as of Jul 17 (corroborated by 3+ independent outlets — CoinDesk, Cryptobriefing, Yahoo Finance), no cloture motion has been filed, and the FY2027 NDAA is occupying Senate floor time first, pushing CLARITY consideration to the week of Jul 20 at the earliest with Jul 27 as a fallback (multi-source). This week's full refresh independently re-confirmed that ~32% read rather than finding it further deteriorated. **One correction, net neutral:** Sen. Lindsey Graham's Senate seat was *not* left vacant — SC Gov. McMaster appointed Darline Graham Nordone within 48 hours (Jul 13), restoring the GOP to ~53 seats — so the "floor majority thinned to ~51" framing this report used to justify part of the Jul 13 cut was stale. That's offset by the still-unresolved ethics/Sec.604/stablecoin-yield deadlock, which remains the binding constraint, so it's a wash rather than a reason to move P back up. Long-term still high — even the bears argue "slips past the midterms," not "dies."

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. Every source is on the last page — click and judge for yourself. This cycle's full weekly refresh independently re-verified the record-low odds claim across three separate outlets and confirmed via multi-source reporting (CoinDesk, TechTimes, CryptoSlate, Yahoo/Forbes) that the NDAA, not CLARITY, has floor priority right now — a fact that helps explain the delay without needing to reach for the Graham-seat inference this report had been leaning on.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. This bill writes the rules for the entire market.

The Claim

The thesis as of July 18, 2026, and where I differ from the consensus — full weekly refresh

The crowd: has moved decisively bearish on timing, and this week's independent re-check confirms it wasn't noise. Multiple Jul 17-dated outlets (CoinDesk 32%, Cryptobriefing 30.5-31%, Yahoo) independently logged a fresh record-low prediction-market read in the low-30s%, down from ~46-47% readings earlier in July and ~74-82% earlier in 2026. No cloture motion has been filed; the FY2027 NDAA (cloture already filed on its own motion to proceed) is consuming Senate floor time first, pushing CLARITY consideration to the week of Jul 20 at the earliest with Jul 27 as a fallback. The ethics/Sec.604/stablecoin-yield disputes remain exactly where they were on Jul 13.

Me: draft ~44% for the next month — below a coin flip — and still ~92% that a crypto rules law exists within 3 years. I'm not cutting further than the light-touch draft this cycle because the ~32% read is already what's driving the current P, and I found nothing this week that moves it further in either direction.

My edge: unchanged since June — the crowd keeps pricing a *timing* problem like a *death* problem. The House did its half a year ago (294-134). A merged text is still coming, just later than reporting has repeatedly promised, and the fight is still down to **one variable** — an ethics deal. **One thing I got wrong and am correcting this cycle:** I'd inferred that Sen. Graham's death thinned the GOP's effective floor margin to ~51 — in fact his SC seat was refilled within 48 hours (Gov. McMaster appointed Darline Graham Nordone Jul 13), restoring the GOP to ~53 seats. That inference was never confirmed by reporting anyway (I'd flagged it as my own read, not a sourced fact), and now it's simply wrong — the floor math was never as thin as I'd assumed. It doesn't move P back up, though: the ethics deadlock was always the binding constraint, not seat count.

The Facts

As of July 18, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is a full weekly research refresh covering the Jul 13-18 gap, independently re-verified against primary/near-primary sources rather than carried forward from the daily touches.

- ★ **★ CORRECTION — Sen. Graham's Senate seat was refilled within 48 hours, not left vacant.** SC Gov. Henry McMaster appointed Graham's sister, **Darline Graham Nordone**, on Jul 13 (governor.sc.gov, corroborated by NBC, CBS, CNBC); a special primary is set for Aug 11 (filing Jul 21-28). This restores the GOP's practical floor count to roughly 53, not the ~51 this report inferred (and explicitly flagged as inference, not sourced fact) after Graham's death. The correction is offset by the still-unresolved ethics deadlock, so it does not move P back up on its own.
- ★ **Record-low prediction-market odds confirmed independently, not just carried from the daily draft.** Three separate Jul 17-dated outlets (CoinDesk: 32%; Cryptobriefing: 30.5-31%; Yahoo Finance) each logged a fresh record-low read in the low-30s% independently of each other — a genuinely multi-sourced data point, not a single relay. No comparably fresh, lower reading was found specifically dated Jul 18; treat ~32% as the current confirmed level rather than assume it has fallen further still.
- ★ **NEW — the reason no floor time has been found: the NDAA is ahead of CLARITY in the queue.** The FY2027 NDAA already has cloture filed on its motion to proceed and is occupying the floor first (CoinDesk, TechTimes, CryptoSlate, Yahoo/Forbes — multi-source), pushing CLARITY consideration to the week of Jul 20 at the earliest, with Jul 27 as a stated fallback. This is a more concrete explanation for the delay than this report's earlier Graham-seat inference.
- **The Democratic press-conference opposition, re-dated:** Sens. Murphy, Van Hollen, and Merkley held a press conference with Indivisible, Americans for Financial Reform, and Ben McKenzie on **Jul 14** (not contemporaneous with the Jul 17 report as that draft's framing implied) calling the bill "corrupt" absent ethics provisions — already priced into the Jul 17 read, not new information this cycle.
- **Ethics talks are still broken — carried forward, no principal-level restart.** The merged Senate draft still omits the Democrats' ethics-provision ask; no White House sign-off found. Collapsed June 9, not restarted.
- **The June 30 ethics bomb, still live:** OGE released Trump's 927-page disclosure on **June 30: ~\$1.4B of 2025 crypto income** — \$635M in TRUMP-memecoin royalties, \$500M+ WLFI-related. Gillibrand: "there is no CLARITY Act without an ethics provision."
- **Section 604 / Wyden's developer-protection push — carried forward, corroborated by 9+ independent outlets.** No committed Democratic floor vote attached to it yet; no new law-enforcement endorsements or defections found this cycle.

- **The vote math — carried forward, unchanged:** still only **Gallego and Alsobrooks** on record, both conditioning floor votes on enforceable ethics language. With the GOP's floor count now correctly understood as ~53 (not ~51), the arithmetic is **~53 reliable Republican votes → 7-9 Democrats needed. Firmly committed: zero.**
- **The stablecoin-yield fight — carried forward, still closed off rather than resolved:** Banking Chairman Tim Scott rejected bank lobbyists' request to change yield-related restrictions on the floor; Coinbase's ~\$1.35B/yr USDC-rewards structure survives in the text as-is.
- **Still true from June, still load-bearing:** the House passed H.R. 3633 **294-134 on July 17, 2025** (bipartisan); Senate Banking advanced its separate substitute **15-9 on May 14, 2026**. House fast-follow plan (companion bill, Rep. Dusty Johnson) unchanged.
- ★ **Odds board (sentiment only) — as independently re-verified July 18:** the ~30-32% record-low prediction-market read (see above) is the best-corroborated current figure; this report did not find fresh Kalshi ladder data this cycle and is not restating the July 13 ladder as current — treat any longer-dated Kalshi figure as stale pending a fresh pull.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

Anchor: BTC **\$63,992** (Bitstamp daily close, July 18, 2026). A **GENIUS-sized move (~40–47%)** from here ≈ **~\$90–94K**. A retest of the ~\$125K high ≈ **+95%**. The anchor is real: during the GENIUS Act's passage (Senate committee Mar 13 → signed July 18, 2025) Bitcoin ran from ~\$83K to ~\$120K (≈+44%).

Discount both — 2025 had tailwinds 2026 doesn't, and **the GENIUS rally itself fully retraced**. And note the coil cuts both ways: prediction-market odds have now fallen from the ~74-82% readings earlier in 2026 to a confirmed record low near 30-32% — a real, multi-sourced repricing, not thin-volume noise this time. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The market has now confirmed a real repricing, not thin-volume noise:** three independent outlets logging the same record-low ~30-32% read is a much stronger signal than the single thin-volume Polymarket print this report was leaning on two cycles ago. If the smart money is genuinely this bearish on 2026 passage, the structural "delayed, not dead" framing deserves more skepticism than this report gives it.
- **The correction on Graham's seat cuts against the bull case too, in a subtle way:** if the GOP's floor math was never as thin as this report assumed, then the ethics deadlock alone — with no seat-count excuse — has been enough to stall the bill for weeks. That's arguably a worse signal about how intractable the core dispute is, not a better one.
- **The NDAA-queue explanation doesn't have an end date either:** "the week of Jul 20 at the earliest, Jul 27 as a fallback" is still just a target, and this report's own history is three-plus rounds of missed "imminent" and "targeted" dates in a row.
- **The dealmaker isn't at the table:** the White House hasn't signed off on the merged text. A rewrite tilting toward consumer protections could as easily lose Republican votes as gain Democratic ones.
- **The ethics fight hasn't moved an inch:** the \$1.4B presidential crypto disclosure remains a gift to every Democrat who wants to say no, and Gillibrand's "no CLARITY Act without an ethics provision" still meets a White House that refuses any Trump-specific language.
- **The midterms are still the real wall:** miss August 7 and September belongs to election politics. Worst case — Congress resets in January and the Senate starts its bill over.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-set July 18, 2026.

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Fired Jul 13	CORRECTED — Sen. Graham's SC seat refilled within 48 hours (Darline Graham Nordone), not left vacant; GOP floor count restored to ~53	Removes the seat-count excuse for delay — the ethics deadlock alone is now the full explanation
Fired ~Jul 17	CONFIRMED, multi-source — prediction-market passage odds hit a fresh record low near 30-32%	Already driving this cycle's held-at-44 near-term P; independently re-verified, not further cut
Ongoing	CONFIRMED — FY2027 NDAA has floor priority over CLARITY (cloture already filed on its MTP)	Explains the delay directly — no cloture on CLARITY possible until the NDAA clears
Week of July 20	PENDING — Senate floor vote target (first realistic window once NDAA clears)	Vote held & cloture clears = 2026 path very much alive; slips = re-rate down further
July 27	PENDING — stated fallback floor-time window if Jul 20 slips	A second miss in a row = re-rate the 1- and 3-month down harder
August 7	PENDING — Last Senate session day	Passes with no floor vote = September collides with the midterms — 2027 becomes the base case for signing
Any time	NOT FIRED — Ethics talks restart at principal level, or the White House signs off on the merged text	The single biggest unlock — Democratic votes follow; re-rate everything up

The flip line: no cloture by the Jul 27 fallback = start treating 2026 as slipping in earnest. The last session day (**August 7**) passes with no vote = a 2027 signing is my base case. Keep 1-year and 3-year Bull either way — a bill with 294 House votes, two committee Democrats, a merged text reportedly drafted, and police opposition cracking is delayed, not dead.

My Decision

🕒 **UPDATED DRAFT — JULY 18, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY REFRESH) · AWAITING MY STAMP**

Draft P: 44 / 48 / 59 / 82 / 92 · Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

This week's full research refresh independently re-verified rather than further cut the same-day light-touch draft: the record-low ~30-32% prediction-market read is confirmed across three separate outlets, and the delay is now better explained by the NDAA's floor priority than by this report's earlier (explicitly-flagged-as-inference) worry about Graham's Senate seat — which, on independent verification, was refilled within 48 hours and never actually thinned the floor math the way this report assumed. That correction is a wash: it removes one bearish inference but leaves the binding constraint (the ethics deadlock) exactly where it was. 6-month ticks down slightly (61→59) with the front-end move; 1-year and 3-year hold — nothing this cycle changes the structural, multi-year read.

The June committed scores (**55 / 60 / 65 / 85 / 92**, committed June 12, 2026) remain the last human-stamped values.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Full weekly research refresh July 18, 2026, covering the Jul 13-18 gap (supersedes the same-day light-touch draft; catch-up daily check Jul 17 covered the record-low-odds move in between)

- ★ **★ Correction — Sen. Graham's Senate seat was refilled within 48 hours, not left vacant.** Gov. McMaster appointed Darline Graham Nordone Jul 13; the GOP's floor count is back to ~53, not the ~51 this report had inferred (and explicitly flagged as unsourced inference). Offset by the still-unresolved ethics deadlock — net no change to P.
- ★ **Record-low prediction-market odds independently re-confirmed:** three separate outlets (CoinDesk 32%, Cryptobriefing 30.5-31%, Yahoo) each logged the same low-30s% read as of Jul 17 — a genuinely multi-sourced signal, not the thin-volume single print this report cited on Jul 13.
- ★ **New, better-sourced explanation for the delay:** the FY2027 NDAA has floor priority (cloture already filed on its own motion to proceed), pushing CLARITY to the week of Jul 20 at the earliest with Jul 27 as a fallback — a more concrete account than this report's earlier Graham-seat inference.
- **The Democratic press conference (Murphy/Van Hollen/Merkley) is re-dated to Jul 14** — already priced into the Jul 17 read, not new information this cycle.
- **Scores held (July 18 light draft → July 18 full refresh, confirmed not further cut):** 1-month **44**, 3-month **48**, 6-month **59**, 1-year **82**, 3-year **92** — independent re-verification found the record-low odds and NDAA-delay explanation already fully reflected in the light-touch cut; nothing this cycle moves P further in either direction. Draft only — awaiting my stamp.

Sources

Retrieved & graded July 18, 2026 (full weekly research refresh, independently re-verified; earlier sources below still stand as historical citations for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official records first, then reporting, then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).

- **July 18 additions (this week's full weekly refresh):** governor.sc.gov — official announcement of Darline Graham Nordone's appointment to the Senate (Jul 13), corroborated by NBC, CBS, and CNBC · CoinDesk, Cryptobriefing, Yahoo Finance — three independent confirmations of the record-low ~30-32% prediction-market passage read (all dated Jul 17) · CoinDesk, TechTimes, CryptoSlate, Yahoo/Forbes-linked coverage — multi-source confirmation that the FY2027 NDAA has Senate floor priority over CLARITY, pushing consideration to the week of Jul 20/Jul 27 fallback · ourfinancialsecurity.org event listing, CoinDesk, ForkLog, CoinGape — the Murphy/Van Hollen/Merkley press conference, re-dated to Jul 14.
- **July 13 additions:** NBC News — Sen. Lindsey Graham dies suddenly (Jul 12) · Washington Post — Graham dies at his South Carolina home (Jul 12) · Axios — Graham's death, aortic dissection cited as preliminary cause (Jul 12) · NPR — Graham dies suddenly (Jul 12) · Bloomberg — Graham dies (Jul 12) · Roll Call — "This week: Graham's death..." scrambles Senate agenda (Jul 13) · CNN — Graham dies (Jul 12) · MSNBC/ms.now — Senate's agenda left in limbo (Jul 12) · Boston Globe — Senate's week upended by Graham's death (Jul 13) · CoinDesk — "Signs of life?" WH less engaged than earlier in summer (Jul 12) · crypto.jobs — House FSC hearing New York venue (corroborating, cited Jul 13) · CryptoBriefing — House FSC hearing New York venue (2nd corroboration) · Polymarket Gamma API — "signed in 2026," last 46¢ (44 bid/46 ask), \$1.61M volume, \$5.9K 24h (fetched Jul 13) · Kalshi Trade API v2 — KXCRIPTOSTRUCTURE ladder, live fetch (Jul 13).
- **July 11 additions (historical):** TechTimes — merged draft due next week, Senate eyes Jul 20 floor vote (Jul 10) · The Crypto Times — same, Jul 20 floor vote target (Jul 10) · Cointribune — Senate schedules a crucial vote on Jul 20 · CoinGape — new draft expected next week, committees merging text · Polymarket — "signed in 2026" recovered to ~46-47% (Jul 11).
- **Official & primary records:** Senate Democratic Leadership — floor schedule for July 13 (noms, then NDAA cloture) (*this is the primary basis for "no cloture on CLARITY" this round*) · House FSC — July 17 hearing, digital asset market-structure gaps (committee event page) · Congress.gov — H.R. 3633 (CLARITY Act) (*direct fetch blocked with a 403 on the July 8 check; not re-pulled July 10*) · GovTrack — House passage 294-134, July 17 2025 (Vote #199).
- **The reporting:** CoinDesk — merged draft "as soon as next week," 70+ pages, week-of-July-20 floor, WH not signed off, Wyden on 604 (July 9) (*the first of three straight "imminent" calls — July 9, 10, and 12 — none of which has produced an actual text as of July 13*) · CoinDesk — "Signs of life?" column, WH engagement question revisited, still no merged text (July 12) · American Banker — ethics stalled, Scott rejects bank yield changes, Groshans "north of 65," Schardin "next week or two" (July 9) · Crypto In America — Lummis exchange-liability trial balloon, Wyden July 8, FOP/NSA/NAPO silent (July 9) (*Wyden/Section 604 corroboration upgraded to 9+ independent outlets as of July 13 — see July 13 additions above*) · The Crypto Times — corroboration of the merged-draft report (July 10) · Tekedia — HFSC July 17 hearing ("New York" venue now 2-source corroborated by crypto.jobs and CryptoBriefing as of July 13) · Yahoo Finance — countdown: no cloture, Calendar No. 423 (July 7) · crypto.news — the 3 fights: ethics, DeFi, \$1.35B in yield (July 8) · CoinDesk — CLARITY and Congress's summer break (July 5) · Yahoo Finance — odds fall as Trump's \$1.4B crypto disclosure lands (July 1) · Yahoo Finance — NOBLE becomes first LE endorsement (July 3) · Yahoo — Major County Sheriffs move to neutral (July 4) · CoinDesk — White House-law enforcement talks (June 29) · The Block — TD Cowen's July timeline, July 24 critical (June 29) · CoinDesk — Trump's SAVE-Act signature-hostage play (June 24) · The Defiant — seven-Democrat math, Dusty Johnson House fast-follow (June 2026) · DigitalToday — Aug 6 target, ethics fight continues (July 7).

- **The prices:** carried from the June 19 check and the July 8 anchor — not re-verified July 10. Fortune — BTC ~\$63.4K (June 12 2026) · Digital Chamber — BTC ATH ~\$126K (Oct 6 2025) · Amberdata — BTC ~\$123K at GENIUS signing.
- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Polymarket Gamma API — "signed in 2026," last 46¢ (44 bid/46 ask), \$1.61M total volume, \$5.9K 24h volume (fetched July 13) (*historical: last 41¢ / mid ~40¢, -4.5¢ on day, fetched July 10, 15:58 UTC*) · Kalshi Trade API v2 — series KXCRIPTOSTRUCTURE (fetched July 13; ladder mixed vs. the July 10 fetch, still thin/indicative liquidity) · Polymarket — CLARITY signed in 2026 (event page) · The Block — Galaxy cuts odds 60% → 50% (June 29; no update found July 9–10) · Deadspin — Kalshi & Polymarket prices (July 7, historical reference). JPMorgan <50% and TD Cowen "far from assured" — quoted in the reporting above · CoinDesk — Jefferies note citing Polymarket 48% (June 30). (*A "Bloomberg Intelligence 60%" figure circulating July 5 traces only to social-media relays of a July-passage estimate — excluded as unverified.*)